process messages.

1.7 Akka actors

So far, you've learned about the actor programming model from a conceptual perspective and seen why you may want to use it. Let's look at how Akka implements the actor model and get closer to where the rubber meets the road. This section examines how everything connects—which Akka components do what—beginning with actor creation.

1.7.1 ActorSystem

The first thing we'll look at is how actors are created. Actors can create other actors, but what creates the first one?

All the actors shown in figure 1.20 are part of the same chat application. The application's first actor is the `Supervisor`. How do you make actors part of one bigger whole? The answer Akka provides is the `ActorSystem`. The first thing every Akka application does is create an `ActorSystem`. The `ActorSystem` can create so-called top-level actors, and it's a common pattern to create only one top-level actor for all actors in the application—in this case, the `Supervisor` actor that monitors everything.